

Isaiah Buchberger
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EDUCATION

The University of Chicago, Chicago, IL
Bachelor of Arts in Anthropology with Honors | 2026
Master of Arts in the Social Sciences | 2026

AWARDS AND HONORS

College Board National Black Excellence Scholarship, 2022–Present
Dean's List 2022-2023; 2024-2026
Mellon Mays Undergraduate Fellowship
Erlach Scholarship
Harper Award for Excellence in Classwork
Institute for Climate and Sustainable Growth India Fellowship

RELAVENT COURSEWORK

Power, Identity, and Resistance I-III (Undergrad)
Autumn 2022, Winter 2023, Spring 2023

Anthropological Theory (Undergrad & Graduate)
Winter 2024

Ethnographic Methods (Undergrad)
Spring 2024

Signs and the State (Undergrad)
Autumn 2024

Utopia's Eclipse? (Undergrad)
Autumn 2024

Doing Multi-Modal Discourse Analysis (Graduate)
Autumn 2025

Democracy in an Age of Global Finance (Graduate)
Autumn 2025

Language in Culture (Graduate)
Winter 2025

Ethnographic Writing (Graduate)
Spring 2026

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Summer Research Training Program, Mellon Foundation

Chicago, IL

Fellow

June 2024 – August 2024

- Participated in two courses, *Writing for Research* and *Engaged Scholarship* which provided me with the skills to critically revise my own and my peers scholarly work.
- Under the preceptorship of a PhD student, I learned the skills to generate and interrogate a research question through a process of weekly literature reviews and one-on-one advisory meetings
- By the end of the program, I produced a 20-page project proposal which outlined previous work done relating to my research, my critical intervention into said scholarship, the theoretical implications of my work, as well as my methodology for going about said research.
- Once completed, I condensed this proposal into a 5-minute presentation which I gave while on a panel at the end of summer conference put on by the program.

Mellon Mays Undergraduate Fellowship Midwest Regional Conference

Chicago, IL; Northfield, IL

Fellow + Panelist

Oct 11-13, 2024; Oct 14-16, 2025

- Engaged in a three-day research conference which both listening, engaging in, and hosting a series of panels done by both students and faculty from Northwestern University, Washington University, Carleton College, and many other universities in the Midwest
- Presented on a panel about the state of my research project which I started earlier in the summer and participated in a questions and answers section following said presentation.

National Undergraduate Research Conference

Richmond, VA

Presenter + Moderator

April 13-15, 2026

- Presented original research over an hour presentation period to audiences ranging from 10-25 people at a conference with over 5,000 attendees
- Chosen to lead and moderate an hour length series of oral presentations; introducing scholars, keeping time, guiding questions afterwards.

Environmental Research Group, University of Chicago

Chicago, IL

Policy Analyst

October 2022 – May 2023

- Co-authored the “Environmental Justice” section of our group’s two-pager on the social and economic costs of lead pollution in water to the Chicagoland area, and later presented this information the rest of the organization.
- Conducted weekly literature review with fellow group members in order to both gain familiarity with comprehending academic journals as well as gain a better understanding in regard to urban lead pollution.
- Filed and processed several FOIAA requests with Cook County and the City of Chicago in attempt to better understand the state of water filtration initiatives announced by both administrations in previous years

Independent Advised Research

“The Blackpill: Misogyny Under Homoeconomicus”

Winter Term 2024

Advisor: Victoria Gross, PhD Assistant Director of MAPSS at the University of Chicago

- Engaged in the relatively experimental methodology of digital ethnography in order to study the ways in which neoliberal rationality could be traced in the discourse of the online “involuntary celibate” community.
- Research spanned two months with the majority of the time spent being dedicated to site indexing to map discursive flows in which the “black pill” is situated, discourse analysis of “incel” forums, and then finally theoretical interpretation of fieldwork.
- The final result of my research was a peer and instructor reviewed paper including both ethnographic “vignettes” as well as analytic and descriptive writing used to both “map out” and interpret the “blackpill” and other themes prevalent in incel discourse.

“The Blackpill: Misogyny Reformulated”

Autumn Term 2024

Advisor: Christopher Bloechl, PhD Teaching Fellow at the University of Chicago

- Built upon previous research done for *“The Blackpill: Misogyny Under Homoeconomicus”* in order to complete a semiotic analysis of incel discourse.
- Created a web-scraper using Scrapy, Python, and Pandas in order to scrape forum data for quantitative and qualitative analysis
- Employed an understanding of fundamental concepts of semiotics such as indexicality as well as more advanced concepts including recontextualization and citationality.
- With this, I was able to make claims about the function of degrading language as both a tool for the management of identity and community, as well as means by which to crowd source and target male rage.

INSTRUCTIONAL EXPERIENCE

Collegiate Scholars Program at the University of Chicago

Chicago, IL

Instructional Assistant for “Afrofuturism in Thought, Literature, and Culture”

June 2023-August 2023

- Facilitated and led all post-lecture discussions with students in order to tailor lecture topics toward students' prior knowledge and current academic interests.
- Prepared and presented lectures to students on the theoretical underpinnings of Afrofuturist thought.
- Assisted in the creation and evaluation of exams for students as well as assist students in creating final portfolio-like project for the class.

PUBLICATIONS AND REPORTS

“Quantifying the Costs of Lead in Drinking Water” Environmental Research Group at the University of Chicago. (2023), <https://enviroresearchgroup.github.io/erg/z-water-quality-chicago.html>

“A Change of Heart in the Fire of the Crucible: Practices and Dispositions in Chicago Tenant Associations” Master Final Thesis involving 4 months of fieldwork resulting in a 70-page report receiving a letter grade of an A and Honors with a nomination for Departmental Award. Advisors: Dr. Gabriel Winant, Dr. Damien Bright, Dr. Ryan Jobson.

Soon to be Published

Book with University of Chicago Press by Andrew Brandel on the history of University of Chicago Anthropology; I served as a Research Assistant for the project and will be given credit upon publication